

CONTACT

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monicacholico.github.io
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SKILLS

Data & Visualization

D3.js, Canvas API, SVG, Scrollama, TopoJSON, GeoJSON, Python, R, Data Analysis

Web Development

HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript ES6, React, Three.js, GLSL, GSAP, Ruby, Astro

Design & Tools

Adobe Creative Suite, Figma, Git, WordPress, SEO, JSON-LD, Agile

Communication

Bilingual (English / Spanish), Explanatory Writing, Information Design

EDUCATION

2026 (IN PROGRESS)

Modern Journalism
NYU & Rolling Stone

2026

Digital Experiences, Marketing & Ecosystems
UNAM Faculty of Arts and Design

2025

Statistics & Probability for Data Analysis
UNAM Faculty of Sciences

2023

UX Principles
UC San Diego

2018

Full Stack Web Development
Codeup

2009 – 2011

Master Studies, Gender, Social & Policy
PRIGEPP FLACSO, Argentina

1996 – 2001

Bachelor's Degree, Law
University of Guadalajara

PORTFOLIO

monicacholico.github.io
planeta-mujer.org
feel-like-dancing.com/blog

Monica Cholico

Creative Developer & Visual Storyteller

EXPERIENCE

The New York Times

2021 – Present

Front-End Software Engineer

- Build interactive, content-driven single-page applications and high-performance advertising templates for NYT's digital platforms
- Collaborate with editorial, UI/UX designers, product teams, and backend developers to deliver engaging web experiences
- Engineer modular, extensible interactive features ensuring seamless cross-browser performance

Planeta Mujer — Data Visualization & Interactive Journalism

2025 – Present

Creator & Developer — planeta-mujer.org

- Conceive, report, and develop data-driven visual stories on gender, policy, and human rights
- Built "50 Million," a scroll-driven data narrative on modern slavery: 10,000 HTML Canvas particles animate across country shapes via D3 force simulation, with Scrollama-driven narration contextualizing 50M victims against historical and demographic scales
- Created an interactive scrollytelling world map of World Bank WBL gender equality scores using D3.js, TopoJSON, and Scrollama with regional zoom across 190 countries
- Designed an SVG hourglass visualization comparing gendered time use (paid work, unpaid work, leisure) across 30 OECD countries
- Built an interactive D3 sunburst taxonomy of feminist thought — from liberal to intersectional — with drill-down navigation into key authors and works
- Implemented SEO, structured data (JSON-LD), Open Graph tags, and analytics across the platform

Feel Like Dancing

2014 – Present

Web Developer, Entrepreneur & Writer — feel-like-dancing.com

- Founded and engineered a high-traffic WordPress platform for ballet dancers in Mexico, managing the end-to-end lifecycle from technical architecture to content publication
- Authored 140+ bilingual (Spanish/English) explanatory articles covering ballet technique, anatomy, history, dancer profiles, and cultural analysis for a niche national audience
- Utilized SEO and data-driven marketing strategies to expand a local niche into a national digital publication
- Analyzed user engagement metrics to iterate on content strategy and interface design

USAA

2019 – 2021

Front-End Software Engineer

- Created and maintained front-end applications, building a library of reusable JS components in a fast-paced Agile environment
- Maintained storefront web pages with HTML, CSS, and Vanilla JS, utilizing a CMS and GitLab

Brokerage Engine

2018 – 2019

Developer — Tier 1 Support

- Augmented existing features with Ruby on Rails (back-end) and React/GraphQL (front-end) for a SaaS company; utilized PostgreSQL, Docker, and Linux

Planeta Mujer — Original Platform

2011 – 2017

Founder, Web Developer & Curriculum Designer

- Founded a digital platform dedicated to gender and policy education; designed interactive curriculum and managed multimedia content to translate complex social issues for a global audience
- Designed and taught 3 online gender courses (Moodle) covering gender theory, policy, power dynamics, and intersectionality

Planned Parenthood of South Texas

2010 – 2011

Community Affairs

- Collaborative storytelling and reporting on healthcare policy; authored press releases and Op-Ed letters explaining reproductive health legislation to the public

U.S. Embassy in Mexico City / Dept. of State

2003 – 2009

Fraud Investigator & Training Designer

- Investigated visa fraud through systematic data analysis, pattern recognition, and evidence-based case building across complex international regulatory systems
- Developed explanatory training materials on fraud prevention for consular staff, making complex investigative methodologies accessible to diverse teams

SELECTED DATA VISUALIZATION PROJECTS

- **50 Million** — Scroll-driven Canvas + D3 data narrative on modern slavery (planeta-mujer.org)
- **WBL Index Map** — Interactive scrollytelling world map of gender equality scores (D3, TopoJSON, Scrollama)
- **Time Use Hourglass** — SVG comparative viz of gendered time use across 30 OECD countries
- **Feminist Theories** — Interactive D3 sunburst taxonomy of feminist thought
- **Global Fertility Rate** — Animated visualization of fertility decline since 1960 (in progress)